



Thomas W. Richards, ABC candidate who won a seat on the Arlington County Board, reads congratulatory telegrams to his wife Ellen, and their two children, Cindy, 5, and Douglas, 7, at their home, 2653 North Richmond street.—Star Staff Photo.

Richards Wins in Last Precinct After Grave Fears of Defeat

By JOHN BARRON
Star Staff Writer

Thomas Richards, who only a few days ago was so discouraged he privately conceded defeat, won election to the Arlington County Board yesterday by 497 votes.

In a tense contest decided only as the last precincts were reported, Mr. Richards, representing the liberal coalition, Arlingtonians for a Better County, ousted the conservative Democratic incumbent, Dr. Lucas Blevins.

Unofficial results of the election in which Arlington residents crowded the polls in record numbers were Richards, 19,939; Blevins, 19,442.

Popular Ernest D. Wilt, whose independent candidacy for the unexpired term of the late David Krupaw was unopposed, amassed 31,922 votes, more than anyone ever got in the county. He already is serving an interim appointment.

Firm Control for ABC

The upset of Dr. Blevins assure the ABC firm control of the County Board for at least another year. It also might mean a shake-up among ranking county employees.

In his campaign, Mr. Richards openly suggested that Planning Director Tom Moore should be fired and indirectly criticized County Manager A. T. Lundberg.

Shortly after the campaign began, Mr. Richards learned he has a coronary ailment. His doctor advised him to curtail his activities. Disregarding the warning, he made more than 60 campaign appearances. All day yesterday until the polls closed, he stood outside polling places in crucial precincts greeting voters. These precincts provided the margin of his victory.

Dr. Blevins said today: "I have been defeated in my bid for re-election and yield to the wishes of my fellow citizens."

"I congratulate Mr. Richards and wish him success in serving



ERNEST WILT

the best interests of Arlington in the coming four years."

Mr. Richards said: "I owe my victory to the hundreds of people who worked so very hard and to the press whose excellent coverage helped enable me to reach the people."

"Arlington voters again have proved they are discriminating and not straight party ticket voters. And they again have demonstrated their faith and confidence in the coalition of Republicans and Democrats, the ABC. I will work hard and sincerely to justify their confidence."

Not Well Known

From the beginning Mr. Richards and other ABC leaders doubted they could unseat Dr. Blevins, a popular and widely known dentist.

The ABC never had won in a presidential election year and Mr. Richards, who is 34, was not well known. The candidacy of Ralph Kaul, an ABC member who unsuccessfully ran for Congress as a Democrat, sapped away some of the coalition's campaign workers. And it was feared that Dr. Blevins would benefit from votes of Democrats supporting Senator Kennedy.

However, the almost professional quality of precinct operations by workers who remained with the coalition together with the indefatigable campaigning of Mr. Richards overcame these handicaps.

As individual precincts slowly disclosed the vote, the lead continually swayed between the two candidates and once, when the count reached about 26,000, only 10 votes separated them.

Carries 19 Precincts

Mr. Richards finally carried 19 precincts, one more than his opponent.

However, he scored decisively in heavy voting areas such as Rosslyn, Thirlington, Rock Spring, Fairlington and Abingdon. And he outpolled Mr. Kaul in Arlington by 429 votes.

Mr. Richards in his campaign pledged to keep Arlington a medium density residential suburb, endorsed higher teacher salaries, promised to fight spot zoning and to work for a regional mass transit system. He refused to promise that he would not vote for tax increases.

Dr. Blevins attacked the ABC for increasing county budgets and taxes and accused the coalition of trying to achieve total domination of Arlington politics.

In January Mr. Richards will join Mr. Wilt, Mr. Kaul, Herbert Brown and Leo Urbanske on the board.

Falls Church Barely Votes Bond Issue

A \$1.2 million public improvement bond issue was approved by a narrow margin yesterday by Falls Church voters in the heaviest voting turnout in the city's history.

About 90 per cent of the city's 3,000 voters gave a 327-vote margin to the passage of the bonds. The total vote was 1,556 for and 1,229 against the proposal. Both freeholders and non-freeholders gave a majority approval to the public improvement program—a requirement for passage of a bond issue in Falls Church.

A total of 1,075 freeholders supported the proposal, while 1,010 opposed it.

Of the \$1.2 million total, \$750,000 will be earmarked for a two-wing addition to George Mason Junior-Senior High School, and \$125,000 will complete remodeling of Madison Elementary School. The remaining \$325,000 is slated for street improvements and storm drain projects.

The city's voting took place for the first time on voting machines. However, despite the automation, there was a 4½-hour delay in making the final tallies from the city's four wards.

FALLS CHURCH

(All Four Wards)	
PRESIDENT	
John F. Kennedy, D.	1,629
Richard M. Nixon, R.	1,523
C. Benton Colner, Cons.	4
Eric Haas, Soc. Labor	4
SENATOR	
*A. Willis Robertson, D.	1,472
Stuart D. Baker, Ind.	483
Clarke T. Robb, Soc. Dem.	96
CONGRESS	
*Joel T. Brothill, R.	1,559
Ralph Kaul, D.	1,396
AMENDMENTS	
ARMED FORCES POLL TAX:	
For	1,002
Against	1,172
ELECTED AREA OFFICIALS:	
For	1,084
Against	1,080
BOND ISSUE:	
For	1,556
Against	1,229
Incumbent: R. Republican; D. Democrat; Cons. Conservative; Soc. Labor; Socialist Labor Party; Ind. Independent; Soc. Dem. Socialist Democrat.	

ALEXANDRIA

(All 22 Precincts)	
PRESIDENT	
John F. Kennedy, D.	9,563
Richard M. Nixon, R.	8,936
SENATOR	
*A. Willis Robertson, D.	11,942
Stuart D. Baker, Ind.	5,209
Clarke T. Robb, Soc. Dem.	1,811
CONGRESS	
*Joel T. Brothill, R.	8,393
Ralph Kaul, D.	8,518
AMENDMENTS	
(17 Precincts)	
ARMED FORCES POLL TAX:	
For	7,478
Against	5,788
ELECTED AREA OFFICIALS:	
For	8,623
Against	8,653
Incumbent: R. Republican; D. Democrat; Cons. Conservative; Soc. Labor; Socialist Labor Party; Ind. Independent; Soc. Dem. Socialist Democrat.	

VIRGINIA

Bitter Struggle Seen In Governor Contest

Continued From First Page
In Richmond, the Associated Press reported, Senator Kennedy's State campaign director, William C. Battle, said, "It was a good hard fight and much closer than a lot of people thought it would be."

Mr. Battle was obviously delighted over the returns from Clarke County which went for Senator Kennedy by a vote of 923 to 804. Clarke County is the home of E. Blackburn Moore, speaker of the House of Delegates, as well as of Senator Byrd, Democratic organization leader who declined to endorse the party's ticket.

In the closing days of the campaign Mr. Moore raised the possibility of a Negro Federal judge being appointed to a Southern court if Senator Kennedy were elected.

Cites Clarke Returns

"Mr. Moore has tried to divide us," Mr. Battle said, "... to pit race against race ... but one of the most gratifying reports to me are the returns from Clarke County."

Mr. Battle was asked if he planned to make a longer statement on the outcome of the election nationally.

"Just say silence is golden," he replied.

That was the way Senator Byrd explained why he didn't want to state his presidential preference.

The 10th District had been counted on by "loyal" Democrats to give Senator Kennedy

at least a 10,000-vote majority to help swing the State their way. Instead, the nearby area tallied nearly a 2,000-vote margin for Mr. Nixon. Alexandria and Falls Church gave the Democrats a slight majority while Arlington and Fairfax Counties voted Republican.

As expected, the 2d District (Norfolk area) voted Democratic by 10,000 votes. The 4th (Southside) District, which has never voted Republican, gave Senator Kennedy a similar majority but the hard-fought 9th District in the Southwest produced only a 2,000-vote edge which, all together was not enough to overcome Republican gains elsewhere.

Vice President Nixon's main strength was, as anticipated, in the Richmond area's 3d District, center of the Democrats for Nixon-Lodge movement, where he piled up a 22,000-vote lead.

Virginia apparently landed in the Republican column again due to three factors:

1. The silence of Senator Byrd.
2. Objections to Democratic Party platform planks dealing with civil rights and promising repeal of authority for States to enact right-to-work laws.
3. A strong drive by the Democrats for Nixon-Lodge which overshadowed Republican efforts.

Senator Byrd's silence was bound to leave lasting scars.

Backed by Many Leaders

With Virginia in the Republican column, many will construe this as a Byrd victory gained over a large number of Democrats who had placed personal stakes in a Kennedy victory.

Among party organization stalwarts who had publicly campaigned for the national Democratic ticket, in varying degrees, were Gov. Almond, former Govs. John S. Battle and Colgate Darden, Jr.; the Democratic national committeeman and committeewoman; State Democratic Chairman Tom Blanton; six members of the House of Representatives; 75 of the 132 Democratic members of the Legislature and lukewarm as it was—the endorsement of Senator Robertson.

Representatives Smith and

Tuck, like Senator Byrd, remained silent to the end.
Y. Alfred Etheridge, Princess Anne County treasurer and a long-time stalwart in the Byrd organization, summed up the views of a growing number of Democrats when he declared at the end of the campaign: "Senator Byrd's silence has given aid to the Republican Party. ... There is no question in my mind that there is new thinking in this State and new Democratic leadership will capture the support of these people. The entire control of the State of Virginia is in for a change."

VIRGINIA PRESIDENTIAL

District	Rep.	Dem.	Cons.	Ind.	Soc. Dem.	Total
First	180	160	34,587	33,702		
Second	91	91	29,289	29,172		
Third	127	128	54,709	52,764		
Fourth	200	195	24,419	24,184		
Fifth	213	243	29,609	27,899		
Sixth	215	214	31,381	34,674		
Seventh	238	250	37,534	34,177		
Eighth	227	236	34,803	30,165		
Ninth	236	244	27,556	29,789		
Tenth	149	148	61,030	59,121		
Totals	1947	1915	394,710	355,127		



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